

Weather

Phone weather app — current, 48-hour hourly, 5-day, animated radar. No ads, no trackers, no analytics, no accounts, no API keys. Repo: [postmaster87/matts-weather-app](https://github.com/postmaster87/matts-weather-app)

Accuracy is ballpark by design — a “do I need a jacket / is that cell going to hit Veenker” app, not a life-safety product. Watches and warnings come straight from the National Weather Service and are the one thing here worth trusting.

What’s on the screen

Section	What it shows
Alerts	Active NWS watches/warnings for the exact point. Tap one to read the full text. Hidden when there are none.
Current	Temp, condition, feels-like, today’s high/low, wind + direction, gust, humidity, UV, sunrise/sunset.
Hourly	Next 48 hours, horizontal scroll. The blue bar under each hour is chance of precip.
5 Day	Day, icon, max chance of precip, and a low-to-high bar scaled across the whole 5 days. Tap a day to swap the hourly strip to that day; tap again for the rolling 48 h.
Radar	10 past frames (~1 hr) plus RainViewer’s 30-minute nowcast. Auto-plays. Drag the slider to scrub, Expand for fullscreen, pinch to zoom. A + on the timestamp means a forecast frame, not an observation.

Location: tap the place name to search any city, or the crosshair to use GPS. The last six places stay as chips in the search screen. Fresh install defaults to Ames, IA.

Install on your phone

On your phone, in Chrome:

1. Open the app URL.
2. Menu (three-dot) -> **Add to Home screen**.
3. It launches fullscreen with no browser chrome and opens instantly from cache.

The last forecast is kept on the device. With no signal it opens and shows the cached data with an orange **Offline — cached 2:14pm** line at the bottom instead of pretending the numbers are current.

Deploy to GitHub Pages

In a browser, on any machine:

1. Go to <https://github.com/postmaster87/matts-weather-app/settings/pages>
2. **Source** -> *Deploy from a branch*
3. **Branch** -> main, folder / (root) -> **Save**
4. Wait ~1 minute. Live at <https://postmaster87.github.io/matts-weather-app/>

No build step. Push to main and it deploys.

Data sources

Source	Used for	Key
Open-Meteo	Forecast (hourly + daily)	No
Open-Meteo Geocoding	Place search	No
api.weather.gov	NWS alerts (US only)	No
RainViewer	Radar tiles + nowcast	No
Esri dark canvas	Radar basemap	No
BigDataCloud	Reverse geocode for the GPS button label	No
Leaflet 1.9.4 (cdnjs)	Map	No

Nothing leaves the phone except the coordinates of the place being looked up. No server, no database, no third-party script beyond Leaflet.

Known limits

- **Radar detail caps at zoom 7.** RainViewer's free tiles do not exist past z7 — deeper zooms return a “Zoom Level Not Supported” placeholder. The radar layer is pinned at z7 and Leaflet upscales, so zooming past regional view gets blocky rather than blank. Map zoom is capped at 10.
- **Alerts are US-only.** api.weather.gov returns nothing outside the US; the alert strip stays hidden.
- **Radar timestamps are in the phone's timezone**, everything else is in the forecast location's local time. Only matters when looking at another time zone.
- **Daily icon vs. daily precip %** can look inconsistent (an overcast icon next to 89%). Both come from Open-Meteo as-is: the icon is the day's dominant condition, the % is the single wettest hour. Not smoothed over.
- Open-Meteo is a model blend, not a nowcast. Treat the hourly numbers as directionally right, not exact.

Files

index.html	markup
app.css	all styling, dark theme, phone-first

app.js	everything else - data, icons, render, radar
sw.js	service worker, caches the shell only
manifest.webmanifest	PWA manifest
icons/	192 / 512 / maskable-512 PNGs

Local preview, from the repo root:

```
python -m http.server 8765
```

Then open <http://localhost:8765>. A service worker is registered, so after editing `app.js` or `app.css`, hard-reload (or bump `CACHE` in `sw.js`) to be sure you are seeing the new file.